

21 4 Hatherley Road

Kew Gardens - 27. IV. 19.

Dear Sir -

Some weeks ago I suggested to Professor
Lunnhead that a translation of Vaihinger's
"Philosophie des Als Ob" would be a useful
addition to the "Library of Philosophy". He had not
read it: but when he had seen my copy, he said
he thought a re-statement would be better than a
translation - and said he would consider any h.d.
I cared to send him - I therefore set about it.
But I am not at all sure that what I am writing
has anything to do with Vaihinger: and if it hasn't
it is probably valueless -

You will not remember, but some years ago you
were good enough to help me, & I did a good deal
of reading with one of your pupils: I have also read
your books carefully, and it puzzles to see how quite
clever people can ignore very important discoveries -
Either I have mis-read you or the world is singularly blind
and stupid: for if your statements are true, we have got
to start rearranging all our ideas just as people had to
when it was found that the earth was not the centre of the
universe. The educational world, for instance, ~~does~~
~~not~~ seems to think that it doesn't matter whether you
are right or wrong!

Remembering your kindness in the past, I venture to
ask whether you could spare the time to read the
first few pages of my h.d.? If you could do that & tell
me frankly what you think of it, ~~it~~ I should know
whether I am fit to teach or whether I ought to be still
learning.

Yours faithfully
W. O. Brigstocke